

Sensors. Smartphones are embedded with sensors like accelerometers, gyroscopes, proximity sensors and more that make these a smart device.

An accelerometer is used to detect the orientation of the device and phone's movements, allowing features like shaking the phone to change music.

A gyroscope works with the accelerometer to detect rotation of phone, for features like tilting the phone that makes gaming easier.

Galaxy S6 also boasts of a fingerprint reader, though in our experience we found this to yield higher error rates compared to Apple's TouchID and the fingerprint sensor in OnePlus 2.

Hardware. Processors are at the core of a device's performance. Higher the number of cores, smoother is the operation.

Nexus uses Qualcomm Snapdragon 805 system on chip (SoC), which is quad-core 2.7GHz Krait 450 with Adreno 420 GPU. Nexus 6, available in 32GB or 64GB models, has double the memory size of Nexus 5.

iPhone 6S is powered with its new A9 processor, which according to Apple is 70 per cent faster than iPhone 6's A8 chip in CPU tasks and 90 per cent faster in GPU tasks. The phone provides an internal storage of more than 8GB that allows having more apps as well as the ability to hold more data, images and the like.

Battery. Smartphones have two types of batteries, namely, removable and non-removable. A removable battery allows you to remove and replace the battery when it gets drained or goes dead, but with a non-removable battery, the handset has to be sent to the service centre in case the battery goes dead.

Battery charging has become easier with the new wireless chargers, which charge the phones faster by placing the handset on the charging plate. Samsung Galaxy Note 5 boasts a 3000mAh battery, which, to the dismay of many Android users, is non-removable. As claimed

by Samsung, it also offers wireless-charging capabilities that can charge Galaxy Note 5 from dead to full in 120 minutes.

Connectivity. Bluetooth is one of the traditional ways of connecting the handset to other Bluetooth-compatible devices for sharing files, photos, videos and the like, wirelessly.

Nexus 6 packs 802.11ac Wi-Fi (with 2x2 MIMO), Bluetooth 4.1, GPS, NFC and Cat 6 4G LTE. For Wi-Fi, Samsung and Sony each support dual-band 802.11ac with MIMO, and Bluetooth 4.1, NFC and GPS. On the other hand, for Samsung or Sony, you will need a nano-SIM to take advantage of its 4G mobile connectivity.

Camera. Smartphone cameras are now capable of capturing high-definition images that can take extremely-detailed photos, which look sharp on a large screen. With flash, bright photos/videos can be shot even in low-light conditions.

iPhone 6 Plus exhibits a couple of features that elevate it above earlier iPhones. One is optical image stabilisation, which even iPhone 6 lacks. This helps counteract camera shake for capturing sharper images even in low light.

Sony Xperia Z5 provides 5x clear image and 8x digital zoom, pulse LED flash and 24mm wide-angle G Lens, apart from being capable of recording 4K video, too.

Besides features, the cult, design, first-factor association and status are some facts that have been identified as the driving factors for choosing these high-priced smartphones. People want to be among the first to adopt the latest in the smartphone market. For instance, an iOS user will buy a new iPhone as it guarantees security due to its proprietary iOS platform.

Buying a high-end smartphone is a matter of choice based on an individual user's needs and requirement. Therefore identifying the correct need and application for which the smartphone needs to be used will make buying simpler. ●

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Does not imply solution